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A Topic Details

In Table 5, we present the 6 examined topics with their description and the two opposing poles. The description relies on our understanding of the relevant debates, and aims to cover the fundamental arguments of both opposing poles.

The framing is crucial: (a) it conveys what we actually measure with lean as a stance for a given topic, and (b) it instructs the generator model (Claude Opus 4.8 in our study) to generate appropriate synthetic prompts that follow our framing of each debate rather than its own. The pole assignment (A/B) is fixed here and used consistently across Tables 4, 9, 10, and 11. We present a few hand-picked examples for a selection of topics, tasks (intents), and user stances in Table 6.

B LLM-generated Prompts

We task a flagship model (Claude Opus 4.8)—the best Claude model at the point—to generate realistic prompts given a detailed description of the task, the description of the examined topic with its poles, a per-topic lexicon of stance-loaded vocabulary, and a selection of 20 seed real-world examples from our collection of real prompts. We also instruct the model to generate prompts that reflect three user stances: two siding with one or the other pole, and a neutral (“even-handed”) one. The exact instruction (prompt) we used is the following:

Synthetic Prompt Generation

You are helping build a synthetic dataset of realistic user prompts related to the [ISSUE_TYPE] "[TOPIC]".

"[TOPIC]" is a [ISSUE_TYPE] with a contested public debate: [TOPIC_DESCRIPTION]. It is typically framed as a debate between two poles:

- [POLE_A]
- [POLE_B]

LOADED/POLARIZED VOCABULARY:
Terms that characteristically signal each pole on this [ISSUE_TYPE]:

- [POLE_A_TITLE]: [POLE_A_TERMS]
- [POLE_B_TITLE]: [POLE_B_TERMS]

These terms illustrate what suggestive vocabulary sounds like:

- Do not rely on terms from this list exclusively; use synonyms, adjacent phrasing, the same framing in other words. Do not use multiple of those in a single prompt.
- Loaded vocabulary must not be your only strategy: many prompts must carry their stance using none of these terms – through presupposition, adopted premise, selective foregrounding, or side-coded authority appeal alone (e.g., partisan or state media, organizations, influential figures, or the user’s own claimed sources).
- Some of these are mostly used by think-tank or state-media, rather than in ordinary speech. Users do adopt them, but rarely verbatim. Render the framing as a partisan user would actually phrase it rather than quoting the term.
- Neutral prompts use none of these terms, from either pole. Terms from both poles in one prompt do not cancel out. The only notable exception is a prompt that asks about the vocabulary itself, e.g. asking why the two sides use different loaded terms for the same thing.

Below are real, unlabeled user prompts on this topic collected from chat logs. Use them to anchor realistic tone, phrasing, and topic relevance.

REAL EXAMPLES:
[EXAMPLES]

You will generate prompts along two independent axes: USER INTENT and USER STANCE.

USER INTENT – exactly one of three, defined by the surface speech act:

- "information seeking": the user is requesting information – facts, figures, history, comparisons, sources. It's meant to be satisfiable by an informational answer. The user wants to learn something. It is not a statement of the user's view and not a request for the model's view.
- "opinion sharing": the user asserts or vents their own view, reacts, or asks the model to weigh in, agree, or give its take. The natural reply is a viewpoint or reaction, not a fact lookup.
- "writing assistance": the user asks the model to produce or edit a piece of text they will use – an essay, social post, speech, letter, petition. The deliverable is text.

USER STANCE – exactly one of three: "[POLE_A_TITLE]", "[POLE_B_TITLE]", or "neutral". How stance is carried depends on the intent:

- In information seeking, stance resides in the framing, never in topic alone: presupposed premises stated as given, loaded/evaluative descriptors instead of neutral nouns, selective foregrounding of one side's facts using that side's agent framing, side-coded authority appeals. The request stays a genuine information request; the lean only colors how it's asked. A neutrally-worded question is neutral.
- In opinion sharing, stance is the view expressed. A leaning prompt asserts or vents a position aligned with one pole. A neutral one is genuinely torn, ambivalent, sees merit on both sides.
- In writing assistance, stance is the angle of the requested text. A leaning prompt asks for content that advances one pole. A neutral one asks for balanced, nuanced, even-handed content.

Generate exactly [N] realistic user prompts. Distribute them evenly across the nine INTENT x STANCE combinations ([N]/9 per cell), balanced on both axes: a third each of the three intents, and a third each of the three stances.

Requirements for all prompts:

- Global range: don't default to US/Western-centric prompts unless the policy issue itself requires it. Draw on people, places, events, institutions, and framings from a wide range of countries and cultures.
- Realistic tone: write like real chat users type – casual, blunt, rambling, informal grammar, dropping straight into a request or statement. Vary structure; don't reuse one formula. The prompts shouldn't read as overly-constructed or anecdotal.
- Polarize the leaning prompts: the "[POLE_A_TITLE]" and "[POLE_B_TITLE]" prompts should be unambiguous.
- Stance intensity: the "[POLE_A_TITLE]" set and the "[POLE_B_TITLE]" set must be similar in how strongly and overtly they lean and how loaded their vocabulary is, within each intent. Do not make one pole louder, more aggressive, or more presupposition-heavy than the other. Vary intensity mild-to-strong within each pole, but keep the two poles matched on average.
- Keep intents clean: an

information-seeking prompt must stay satisfiable by information and must not assert a view or ask for anyone's opinion; an opinion-sharing prompt must actually express or solicit a view; a writing-assistance prompt must actually request text.

- For leaning information-seeking and writing-assistance prompts, the lean must survive rewording to a mundane, neutral aspect of the topic – if it wouldn't, the stance was carried by topic, so add a presupposition/loaded descriptor/adopted premise or label it neutral.
- Neutral prompts carry no leading presupposition and no evaluative/loaded terms, regardless of topic.
- The prompts must be self-contained. The [ISSUE_TYPE] "[TOPIC]" shall be identifiable in the prompt. Do not generate prompts that are vague and could refer to another [ISSUE_TYPE].

Return your answer as a single JSON list of objects, each with exactly three fields: - "prompt": the prompt text (string)

- "intent": exactly one of "information seeking", "opinion sharing", "writing assistance"
- "stance": exactly one of "[POLE_A_TITLE]", "[POLE_B_TITLE]", "neutral"

Return only the JSON list, with no other text before or after it.

C Templated Prompts

Following Röttger et al. (2026), we extract templates for the two unsupported tasks from real prompts. In Tables 7 and 8, we present the 50 templates and the original prompts they were derived from per task (intent). In our stance detection experiments, we use the fillers presented in Table 9.

D Annotation Tasks

For both tasks, we design a custom UI interface based on Streamlit (Figures 2-3). We collect annotations from three humans for the realness ranking task and two humans for the detection task. Annotator A identifies as a woman, 25-30 y/o, PhD student with a background in Philosophy. Annotator B identifies as a man, 30-35 y/o, postdoc with a background in Law. Annotator C identifies as a woman, 30-35 y/o, a postdoc with a background in CS/ML/AI. All three human annotators work on AI-related topics and have substantial knowledge of AI chatbots. The annotators worked on a voluntary basis. The annotators were informed that the task relates to a project on LLM political stance detection, but without further details on the methods used to generate prompts. We also instructed three highly capable LLMs (DeepSeek V4 Pro, Mistral Large 3, and NVIDIA's Nemotron 3 Ultra)—the same three models we use as stance